

AZTHREUS SYSTEMS: CONSOLIDATED HUMAN RESOURCES POLICIES

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1. EMPLOYEE ONBOARDING & ORIENTATION

(AZ-HR-002 — complete before Day 1 through Day 90)

1.1 Pre-Employment Requirements

Background Investigation: Standard roles → criminal history, 10yr employment verification, education verification. Mission-Critical roles (safety software, mission control, crypto systems) → Single Scope Background Investigation (SSBI) equivalent; no mission-critical access until clearance confirmed in writing.

Pre-Arrival Documentation (before Day 1): Signed Employment Contract, Proof of Citizenship/Work Authorization, Equipment Preference Form, Export Control Acknowledgment (ITAR/EAR), Non-Disclosure Agreement. **Day 1:** Emergency Contact Form, Conflict of Interest Disclosure. Late submissions may delay system access.

Export Control Acknowledgment: Mandatory before any repository/docs access. Understand: no sharing controlled data with non-authorized personnel, citizenship/export-license restricted repos, severe penalties for violations.

1.2 90-Day Onboarding Plan

Phase 1 — Foundation (Days 1-30): Week 1: badge/biometric registration, security awareness training (2h), ITAR/EAR compliance (1h), meet Onboarding Buddy, New Employee Orientation, workstation configuration. Weeks 2-4: read Corporate Policies Manual (Vol 1 & 2), About Us doc, tech stack overview; attend Architecture Overview; shadow 2 peers; complete domain reading list (DTN/Bundle Protocol, Quantum Computing, Radiation Hardening, OAIS). Milestone Review at Day 30.

Phase 2 — Integration (Days 31-60): Join live project under Senior Engineer supervision. Submit ≥ 2 Merge Requests. Attend ≥ 1 Sprint Review/Project Status Meeting. Write ≥ 1 technical documentation piece. Complete Cognitive Readiness Orientation (if Mission Control/Safety-Critical). Milestone Review at Day 60 (manager + Onboarding Buddy).

Phase 3 — Independence (Days 61-90): Lead ≥ 1 feature from definition to reviewed MR. Participate as primary reviewer in peer code review. Update/improve ≥ 1 documentation section. Complete Role-Specific Certification. 90-Day Review determines: independent commit access (via MR workflow), 12-month Individual Development Plan, enrollment in 40-hour Continuous Professional Education.

Role-Specific Certifications (within 90 days): Safety-Critical SWE → NASA NPR 7150.2D Fundamentals. Quantum SWE → Qiskit/Q# Orientation. Mission Controller → Flight Rules & Command Uplink Authority Training. Data Scientist → Data Governance Classification Acknowledgment. Systems Architect → Configuration Management Baseline Training. Security Engineer → NIST PQC Standards Overview.

1.3 Organizational Reporting Structure

Executive Board → CEO → CTO (Systems Architecture, Quantum Engineering, Deep Space Comms, F
→ CISO (Info Security, CIRT)
→ COO (Mission Operations, Infrastructure, Supply Chain)
→ HR Director, Quality Manager, Legal & Compliance Officer, Finance

Communication: Internal messaging for daily, email for formal/external. Daily 15-min standup + weekly planning. Architecture-impact decisions recorded as ADRs. Safety/escalation → Systems Architect or CTO within 24h.

1.4 Systems Access Provisioning

Day 1: Corporate email, internal messaging, documentation wiki (read-only), HR self-service portal.

After Phase 1 clearance: VCS read access, issue tracker, CI/CD dashboard. **After 90-Day Review:** Write access (MR workflow only), production log monitoring (read-only, role-dependent).

Workstation Baseline: Full-disk encryption (AES-256). EDR agent installed/active. OS at current approved baseline. Screen lock ≤ 5 min inactivity. Personal cloud storage prohibited.

2. LEAVE & PAID TIME OFF

(AZ-HR-003 — PH and US jurisdictions)

2.1 Philippines Entitlements

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Carry-Over
Vacation Leave	15 days (1.25/mo accrual)	Up to 15 days; excess cashed out in January
Sick Leave	15 days (1.25/mo accrual)	Up to 10 days; excess forfeited
Maternity (RA 11210)	105 days paid (100% avg daily salary, employer + SSS)	Non-cumulative; additional 15 days for solo mothers (RA 8972)
Paternity (RA 8187)	7 days paid, first 4 deliveries, within 60 days of delivery/miscarriage	Non-cumulative
Solo Parent (RA 8972)	7 additional paid days/year (valid DSWD ID required)	Non-cumulative
Special Women's Leave (RA 9710)	Up to 2 months paid (gynecological surgery, ≥6mo service)	Non-cumulative
Bereavement	Spouse/child/parent: 5 days. Sibling/grandparent/parent-in-law: 3 days. Other: 1 day. Within 10 calendar days.	Death certificate within 30 days
Emergency Leave	Up to 3 days/year, manager discretion, documentation if obtainable	

Leave usable after 6 months continuous service (except sick leave upon accrual). Leave Without Pay available after exhausting entitlements (manager + HR approval; does not interrupt continuity of service for statutory benefits).

[EXPANDED]

2.1.1 Leave Without Pay (LWOP) — Detailed Impact on Benefits and Tenure

LWOP availability: after exhausting all paid leave entitlements (VL, SL, EL). Requires manager approval + HR Director approval. Maximum LWOP: 30 calendar days per rolling 12-month period without formal Executive Board petition.

Impact on Tenure and Seniority:

Benefit	Rule
Service Continuity (PH)	LWOP of ≤30 calendar days does not break continuity of service for statutory benefits under the Philippine Labor Code. LWOP of 31-60 calendar days: service is deemed interrupted but not severed — employee retains seniority credit for years served prior, but the LWOP period does not count toward future tenure accrual. LWOP >60 calendar days: continuity is broken; employee restarts from zero for purposes of security of tenure and regular employment status.
Service Continuity (US)	FMLA eligibility: LWOP does not count toward 1,250-hour threshold but does not break the 12-month employment requirement. For at-will employment, LWOP >30 calendar days without formal approval constitutes job abandonment.
Seniority Accrual (PH)	Vacation leave accrual rate (1.25 days/month) pauses during LWOP. Seniority for purposes of layoff priority, promotion eligibility, and benefit tiering continues to accrue if LWOP ≤30 days. If LWOP >30 days, seniority credit pauses from the 31st day forward.
Seniority Accrual (US)	PTO accrual pauses during LWOP. Seniority for bonus pool calculations and title eligibility pauses from the first day of LWOP (US does not credit LWOP toward tenure milestones).

Impact on Compensation and Benefits:

Benefit	Rule
13th Month Pay (PH)	13th month pay is computed on basic salary actually earned during the calendar year (Presidential Decree No. 851). LWOP days are excluded from the computation — no basic salary earned = no 13th month credit for those days. Example: 30 days LWOP in a year reduces 13th month pay by approximately 8.2% (30/365).
401(k) Vesting (US)	Vesting of employer matching contributions pauses during LWOP. If LWOP exceeds 30 calendar days and the employee is in the first 3 years of employment (cliff vesting), the vesting schedule is extended by the number of LWOP days beyond 30. Example: 45 days LWOP → 15 days added to cliff vesting schedule. Fully vested employees are not affected.
Bonus Eligibility (PH and US)	LWOP of ≤15 calendar days: no impact on annual bonus eligibility. LWOP of 16-30 calendar days: bonus eligibility preserved but bonus amount prorated by the ratio of LWOP days to total workdays in the bonus period. LWOP >30 calendar days: employee forfeits annual bonus eligibility for the year in which the LWOP occurred.
Health Insurance (PH — PhilHealth)	Employer share of PhilHealth contributions pauses during LWOP. Employee may continue paying personal share voluntarily. LWOP >30 days: employer must notify PhilHealth of gap in contributions.
Health Insurance (US)	COBRA eligibility triggers if LWOP exceeds 30 calendar days and employee loses group health coverage. Employee may elect COBRA continuation at own expense. Employer may, at discretion, continue coverage during LWOP ≤30 days.
Equity/Stock Vesting	If Azthreus has equity compensation: vesting pauses during LWOP. LWOP >30 days: unvested equity may be subject to accelerated clawback per equity plan terms. Consult Legal Officer.

LWOP Approval Criteria (Manager + HR Director): 1. All paid leave entitlements exhausted (verified by HR) 2. Written request with reason for LWOP and expected return date 3. Manager confirms: no operational criticality conflict, coverage plan for employee's duties 4. HR Director confirms: no statutory benefit forfeiture risk exceeds employee's stated acceptance 5. Employee acknowledges in writing: understanding of LWOP impacts on tenure, seniority, benefits, and vesting as documented above 6. LWOP >30 days: requires Executive Board petition with business justification and employee's written acknowledgment of benefit impacts

2.2 United States Entitlements

PTO (Vacation + Personal): 0-2yr → 15 days (120h), accrual 1.25/mo. 2-5yr → 20 days (160h). 5+yr → 25 days (200h). Usable after 90 days (manager discretion). Max carry-over: 10 days. Accrual pauses at 1.5x annual rate. Resignation with ≥2wk notice: accrued PTO paid out. Termination: per state law.

Sick Leave: 10 days (80h) per calendar year. Non-accruing — full balance Jan 1 (prorated for new hires). No carry-over, no payout on separation. Use: own illness/injury/appointment, care of ill family member, domestic violence/assault/stalking situations.

FMLA: Eligible after 12mo + 1,250h. Up to 12 weeks unpaid/12mo for birth/adoption/foster, serious health condition, family military exigency. Up to 26 weeks for covered servicemember care. Group health maintained. Accrued PTO/sick leave used concurrently. 30-day notice where foreseeable.

Parental Leave (company policy, above FMLA): Primary caregiver → 12 weeks at 100% salary. Secondary caregiver → 4 weeks at 100% salary. Must be taken within 12 months of birth/adoption/placement. May be continuous or intermittent (with manager approval).

Bereavement: Same as PH (5/3/1 days by relationship). Additional time from PTO. Within 10 calendar days.

Jury Duty: Full pay for duration. Copy of summons to HR. Report to work when not required.

Voting Leave: Per applicable state law. Advance notice to manager.

2.3 Leave Procedures (All Employees)

Submit through HR self-service portal. Notice: Vacation/PTO → 5 working days. Extended leave (5+ days) → 10 working days. Medical (unplanned) → before start of scheduled workday if possible. Maternity/Paternity/Parental → 30 days. Bereavement → as soon as practicable. Managers respond within 3 working days. Denial only for documented operational reasons with basis stated. Mission-critical project phase deadlines are acceptable; routine workload is not with sufficient notice.

Probationary Employees: Accrued sick leave usable. VL/PTO credited but not usable until end of probation (except medical necessity/bereavement at HR discretion).

Mission-Critical Assignments: Class A project engineers may be asked to defer non-urgent planned leave during active mission phases. Deferral must be agreed (not imposed). Rescheduled date confirmed within 10 working days. Leave cannot be forfeited.

Return from Extended Leave (4+ weeks): Return-to-work meeting before safety-critical duties. Cognitive readiness check for roles requiring certification (Procedure 9.2.1.2).

Records: Leave records maintained by HR, classified L3 (Confidential) per AZ-DATA-001. Medical info separate from personnel files. Managers informed of approval status and return dates only. Retention: employment + 7 years.

3. HOLIDAY SCHEDULE

(AZ-HR-004 — annual schedule published by December 15)

3.1 Philippines

Regular Holidays (paid 100% not working, 200% working, 260% on rest day): New Year's Day (Jan 1), Araw ng Kagitingan (Apr 9), Maundy Thursday (movable), Good Friday (movable), Labor Day (May 1), Independence Day (Jun 12), National Heroes Day (last Mon Aug), Bonifacio Day (Nov 30), Immaculate Conception Day (Dec 8), Christmas Day (Dec 25), Rizal Day (Dec 30), Eid'l Fitr & Eid'l Adha (movable).

Special Non-Working Days (Azthreus pays as not-working; 130% if working, 150% on rest day): Chinese New Year, EDSA Revolution (Feb 25), Black Saturday, Ninoy Aquino Day (Aug 21), All Saints Day (Nov 1), All Souls Day (Nov 2), Christmas Eve (Dec 24), Last Day of Year (Dec 31).

3.2 United States

11 Federal Holidays Observed: New Year's Day, MLK Jr. Day (3rd Mon Jan), Presidents' Day (3rd Mon Feb), Memorial Day (last Mon May), Juneteenth (Jun 19), Independence Day (Jul 4), Labor Day (1st Mon Sep), Columbus/Indigenous Peoples Day (2nd Mon Oct), Veterans Day (Nov 11), Thanksgiving (4th Thu Nov), Christmas Day. If Saturday → observed Friday. If Sunday → observed Monday.

Floating Holidays: 2 per calendar year (prorated for mid-year hires). Use any day with standard leave request procedure. No carry-over, no payout.

Holiday Pay (US): Not working → regular pay. Required to work → regular pay + 1 day PTO credit. On approved paid leave → not counted against leave balance. Part-time: prorated by scheduled hours.

3.3 Cross-Jurisdiction

Annual schedule for both jurisdictions published Dec 15. Project plans must account for non-overlapping holidays. No cross-jurisdiction meeting assumptions on local holidays. Mission Ops Lead maintains coverage across all holidays. Employees cannot be assigned mandatory on-call for both jurisdictions' holidays in same month without agreement. Same-date holidays: cross-team non-emergency comms suspended.

3.4 Religious/Cultural Accommodations

Non-schedule observances: use VL/PTO (PH), floating holiday (US), or Emergency Leave (PH).

Recurring observances (e.g., weekly Sabbath, Friday prayers): schedule accommodations, not leave.

Reasonable accommodation consistent with applicable law.

4. REMOTE WORK & FLEXIBLE ARRANGEMENTS

(AZ-HR-005)

4.1 Work Arrangement Types

Type	Definition
On-Site	Primary location is Azthreus office/facility
Hybrid	Split between office and remote per agreed schedule
Fully Remote	Primary location outside Azthreus facility; required on-site for onboarding (first 2 weeks), quarterly planning, gate reviews, annual all-hands, security/mission-required meetings

4.2 Role Eligibility & On-Site Minimums

Role	Eligible Arrangements	Min On-Site (Hybrid)
Mission Controller (active)	On-Site only	N/A
Safety-Critical SWE (active sprint)	Hybrid	3 days/week
General SWE	Hybrid or Fully Remote	1 day/week recommended
Data Scientist/AI Engineer	Hybrid or Fully Remote	1 day/week recommended
Systems Architect	Hybrid or Fully Remote	2 days/week
Security Engineer (CIRT)	Hybrid	2 days/week (more during active incidents)
Admin/HR/Finance	Hybrid or Fully Remote	As agreed
Quantum Engineering (hw access)	On-Site or Hybrid	Per hardware access schedule

4.3 Cross-Border Remote Work

<30 consecutive days/calendar year: HR approval with Legal review. 30-60 consecutive days: Legal Officer sign-off (tax/employment law). >60 consecutive days: requires formal contract amendment (change of jurisdiction). Export-controlled work (Procedure 18.1.1.1) may not be performed from prohibited jurisdictions regardless of duration.

4.4 Remote Security Requirements

Network: Company-approved VPN mandatory for all access to Azthreus systems. Public Wi-Fi prohibited for L3/L4 data without active VPN. Home networks: WPA2/WPA3, non-default router password. Wired Ethernet strongly recommended for L3/L4. **Physical Security:** Workspace must prevent unauthorized viewing of L3/L4 data. Privacy screen required for L3/L4 in shared spaces (IT provided). Sensitive physical documents must not be left unattended. Disposal per AZ-DATA-001. **Device:** Only company-provisioned or IT-approved BYOD. Screen lock ≤5 min. Devices never left unattended in public. Patches: 72h for standard, same business day for IT-pushed mandatory. **L3 Additional Requirements:** VPN always-on (not just when accessing specific systems). Company-

provisioned device only. Dedicated workspace inaccessible to household members during work hours. **L4 Remote Access:** Explicit CISO approval for each session. Not permitted by default; exceptional only.

4.5 Incident Reporting (Remote)

Suspected compromised home network/device: 1) Disconnect from VPN and home network immediately. 2) Contact CIRT hotline. 3) Do not remediate yourself. 4) Use alternate device until IT Security assesses.

4.6 Equipment & Connectivity

Standard Remote Kit: Laptop (company-provisioned), VPN client pre-configured, EDR pre-installed, privacy screen filter. **Additional (manager approval):** External monitor, ergonomic keyboard/mouse, headset, desk webcam. High-value (>USD 500) requires COO approval. **Internet Allowance (fully remote):** PH → PHP 1,500/mo. US → USD 60/mo. Non-taxable reimbursement upon monthly invoice submission.

4.7 Flexible Hours

Core Hours: PH employees → 9:00 AM-12:00 PM PST (UTC+8). US → flexible but overlapping with PH core hours ≥2 days/week. Outside core hours: flexible, subject to total weekly hours meeting contract, on-call obligations, manager awareness. **Compressed Schedules** (e.g., 4x10): manager + HR approval; not for Mission Controllers or on-call security roles.

4.8 Manager Responsibilities

Ensure remote employees have equivalent information/tools/opportunities. Weekly one-on-ones for fully remote. No two-tier communication environment. Monitor for isolation/overwork/burnout. Do not exclude remote employees from career development/mentoring/visibility.

5. CODE OF CONDUCT & DISCIPLINARY POLICY

(AZ-HR-006)

5.1 Standards of Professional Conduct

Integrity: Accurate information in reports/code/docs/test results — falsification endangers missions. Honest about own qualifications. Disclose conflicts of interest. No misuse of company systems/data/resources. **Safety Reporting:** Any condition compromising mission safety or human

life must be reported (Procedure 8.1.2). Not optional. Reporter identity protected. Retaliation prohibited. **Respect & Inclusion:** Zero tolerance for harassment (sexual harassment → immediate termination on substantiation). No discrimination per PH (RA 7877, RA 11313) and US (Title VII, state law) protected characteristics. No bullying, intimidation, threats. No derogatory jokes/slurs. No retaliation against good-faith reporters. **Confidentiality:** Per AZ-DATA-001 and AZ-LEGAL-001. No sharing Confidential/Mission-Critical info outside authorized channels. No discussion of confidential projects in public. No disclosure of colleague salaries/performance/personal info. Honor post-termination NDAs. **Technology Use:** Business purpose primarily. Incidental personal use must not: interfere with work/system performance, access illegal/offensive material, circumvent security controls, be for personal commercial activity. No expectation of privacy on company devices/network. **Conflicts of Interest:** Disclose to manager + HR: financial interests in vendors/suppliers/competitors, outside employment/consulting, personal relationships affecting employment/procurement decisions. Disclosure ≠ automatic conflict. **Alcohol/Substances:** Not under influence while performing duties, especially safety-critical. Immediately removed from safety-critical duties if impaired. Applies at company-sponsored events.

5.2 Harassment & Complaint Procedure

Report Channels: Direct Manager (if not involved), HR Director, Ethics Hotline (anonymous), Senior Leadership (HR Director concerns or prior unaddressed reports). **Process:** HR acknowledges within 2 business days. Investigator assigned (external for senior personnel). Interviews with reporter, subject, witnesses. Documents/comm logs reviewed. Finding: substantiated/unsubstantiated/inconclusive. HR determines response. Confidentiality maintained; subject informed of investigation, reporter identity protected where legally permissible. **Interim Measures:** Reassignment, access restriction, administrative leave with pay (not disciplinary, not a finding).

5.3 Disciplinary Procedures

Infraction Classification: **Minor** → isolated, correctable, no danger, no dishonesty. **Moderate** → repeated minor, team function impact, negligent policy violation. **Serious** → intentional violations, safety endangerment, harassment, dishonesty, fraud, serious confidentiality breach. **Gross Misconduct** → physical violence, sexual assault, deliberate system sabotage, safety-critical record falsification, serious criminal conduct.

Progressive Discipline: Verbal Warning (minor, first) → Written Warning (minor repeated / first moderate) → Performance Improvement Plan (persistent moderate / significant performance concerns) → Final Written Warning (serious with mitigating circumstances) → Termination (gross misconduct or PIP failure). Steps may be skipped (single serious infraction → immediate termination).

Jurisdiction-Specific Termination: PH: Just cause/authorized cause per Labor Code. Due process: first written notice, 5-day hearing opportunity, second notice of decision. HR must be involved from first notice. Non-compliance may result in damages even with just cause. **US:** At-will generally, but Azthreus follows progressive discipline for fairness. Terminations on protected characteristics unlawful. HR reviews/approves all US terminations before notice.

Employee Rights: Informed of specific conduct/performance concern. Provide account before decision. Accompanied by representative where permitted. Appeal within 10 calendar days to HR Director. Appeal panel (HR Director, uninvolved senior leader, external advisor if needed): uphold, modify, or overturn. Panel decision final internally (does not affect rights to government labor bodies).

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5.3.1 Investigation Timelines — Mandatory Schedule

All workplace investigations (harassment, policy violations, safety misconduct, fraud, confidentiality breaches) must follow the timeline matrix below. These timelines are **mandatory**, not aspirational. Deviations require written approval from the COO with documented justification.

A. Investigation Phase Timelines

Phase	Maximum Duration	Responsible Party	Deliverable
Phase 1: Preliminary Assessment	3 business days from report receipt	HR Director or designee	Written determination: (a) investigation warranted, (b) matter resolved informally, or (c) no action required with rationale. If investigation warranted, assign Investigator.
Phase 2: Investigation Planning	2 business days from Investigator assignment	Investigator	Investigation Plan: scope, interview list, document requests, evidence preservation steps, estimated completion date. Filed with HR.
Phase 3: Evidence Collection	5 business days from Investigation Plan approval	Investigator	All interviews completed, documents collected, digital evidence preserved (with CISO for digital forensics if needed).
Phase 4: Analysis & Findings	3 business days from Evidence Collection completion	Investigator	Draft Investigation Report with findings: substantiated / unsubstantiated / inconclusive. Specific factual findings for each allegation.
Phase 5: Subject Response	3 business days from draft report distribution to HR Director	Subject (respondent)	Written response to findings (optional but strongly encouraged). Subject may be accompanied by representative.
Phase 6: Decision	3 business days from Subject Response deadline	HR Director + Legal Officer	Final Investigation Report. Determination of appropriate disciplinary action (if any). Communicated to subject and reporter (to extent permissible).
TOTAL (standard investigation)	19 business days from report receipt to decision		

B. Extended Investigation (Complex Cases)

When an investigation cannot be completed within the standard 19-business-day timeline due to complexity (e.g., multiple subjects across jurisdictions, digital forensics requiring external vendors, witness unavailability due to travel/mission operations), the following applies:

1. **Extension Request:** Investigator submits written extension request to HR Director before the Phase deadline. Must include: specific reasons for extension, revised timeline, interim measures taken to protect reporter/subjects.
2. **Extension Approval:** HR Director may grant up to one extension of **10 additional business days**. Total maximum: 29 business days.
3. **Second Extension:** If additional time needed beyond 29 business days, COO approval required. COO may grant up to one additional extension of **10 business days** (total maximum: 39 business days).
4. **Beyond 39 business days:** Executive Board must be notified. Investigation continues under interim measures. HR Director provides Executive Board with weekly status updates until completion.
5. **Interim Measures During Extension:** Subject may be placed on administrative leave with pay (not disciplinary). Access restrictions may apply. Reporter must be protected from retaliation. All interim measures documented.

C. Gross Misconduct Expedited Investigation

For allegations involving Gross Misconduct (physical violence, sexual assault, deliberate system sabotage, safety-critical record falsification), the following expedited timeline applies:

Phase	Maximum Duration
Preliminary Assessment + Interim Measures	1 business day (same day if possible)
Evidence Collection (priority)	3 business days
Analysis & Findings	2 business days
Subject Response	1 business day
Decision	1 business day
TOTAL (gross misconduct)	8 business days

D. Escalation for Missed Deadlines

Missed Deadline	Escalation Path
Phase 1 (Preliminary Assessment) exceeds 3 days	HR Director notifies COO immediately. Investigator reassigned if capacity issue.
Phase 3 (Evidence Collection) exceeds 5 days	Investigator submits extension request to HR Director. If no request submitted, HR Director reassigns investigation.
Standard investigation exceeds 19 business days without extension approval	COO notified. Investigator must submit extension request or investigation reassigned.
Extended investigation exceeds 29 business days	Executive Board notified. HR Director provides status update.
Gross misconduct investigation exceeds 8 business days	COO + Legal Officer notified. Written justification required.

E. Reporter and Subject Communication Obligations

Party	Communication	Timeline
Reporter	Acknowledgment of receipt	Within 1 business day of report
Reporter	Status update (investigation is underway; outcome details limited)	At conclusion of each phase
Reporter	Final outcome notification (to extent permissible by law and policy)	Within 3 business days of final decision
Subject	Notification of allegations and investigation	Within 2 business days of Phase 2 (unless risk of evidence destruction, then delayed to Phase 3)
Subject	Opportunity to respond to findings	Phase 5 (3 business days)
Subject	Final decision notification	Within 3 business days of Phase 6 decision

F. Documentation and Retention

All investigation records (reports, interview notes, evidence, correspondence, decisions) are classified L3 (Confidential) and retained for: employment + 7 years (standard), or indefinitely if litigation is pending or reasonably anticipated. Investigation records are maintained in a secure, access-controlled investigation file system separate from general HR personnel files. Access limited to: HR Director, Legal Officer, CISO (if security-related), and Executive Board (if escalated).

5.4 Mission-Critical Role Provisions

Cognitive Readiness: Safety-critical employees reporting for duty impaired (fatigue, substances, stress) and not disclosing it violate policy AND professional ethics (Procedure 8.1.1). **Disclosing reduced readiness and requesting reassignment is protected — not disciplinary.** **Whistleblower Protection:** Good-faith reports of safety/legal/regulatory/financial violations through any legitimate channel are protected. Retaliation = serious infraction up to termination regardless of underlying report outcome.

6. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & CAREER DEVELOPMENT

(AZ-HR-007)

6.1 Performance Review Cycle

Annual Performance Review (APR): November-December. Employee self-assessment → Manager assessment → Peer/stakeholder input (Senior+ or manager discretion) → Calibration discussion (cross-manager rating consistency) → One-on-one APR meeting → Finalized rating + development goals. **Mid-Year Check-In (May-June):** Progress against IDP goals, priority changes, surface concerns early. Not a rating event. Documented in HR portal. **Continuous Feedback:** Formal minimum; managers expected to provide specific/timely feedback after significant milestones, MR reviews, gate reviews, mission events.

6.2 Performance Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Description
4	Exceptional	Consistently exceeds expectations in impact/quality/scope. Exemplifies values.
3	Effective	Meets all and frequently exceeds expectations. Reliable, high-quality. Standard for well-performing employee.
2	Developing	Partially meets expectations. Identifiable gaps requiring focused development plan.
1	Not Meeting	Significantly below expectations. Formal PIP per AZ-HR-006 Section 4.2.

3 (Effective) represents strong performance — not mediocre. A majority of well-performing employees should receive 3. Rating inflation undermines system integrity.

6.3 Individual Development Plan (IDP)

Every employee has IDP as APR outcome. Captures: 12-month development goals, 2-5 year career aspirations, learning activities (training, stretch assignments, mentoring), company support (training budget per AZ-FIN-001 Section 4.1). Employee-owned, manager-enabled. **Development Goal Categories:** Technical Skills (language, framework, domain), Mission Domain Knowledge, Engineering Craft (code quality, design, testing), Leadership/Collaboration, Professional Certifications.

6.4 40-Hour Continuous Professional Education

Per Policy 9.3.1, all employees complete ≥ 40 hours approved professional education annually. IDP activities are primary mechanism. Tracked in HR portal. Factor in APR. Extenuating circumstances documented; failure noted as developing area.

6.5 Career Framework

Level	Titles	Expectations
L1: Associate	Associate Engineer/Scientist	Learning role, close supervision
L2: Mid-Level	Software Engineer, Data Scientist, Security Analyst	Independent on defined tasks, competent core requirements, occasional L1 mentoring
L3: Senior	Senior SWE/Architect/ML Engineer	Leads complex work, significant design contributor, mentors L1/L2, may lead small teams
L4: Principal/Lead	Principal Engineer, Engineering Lead, Systems Architect	Organization-wide technical impact, owns major systems/domains, sets standards
L5: Distinguished	Distinguished Engineer, Chief Architect	Rare. Shapes entire technical direction. External recognition

Management track exists in parallel. ICs may advance to L4/L5 without moving to management.

6.6 Promotion Process

Sustained performance at next level expectations (promotion recognizes demonstrated capability, not future potential). Manager nomination with specific behavioral evidence. HR review (consistency, compensation band). L4/L5: review panel including CTO/department head. Effective January 1 following APR confirmation. Off-cycle requires COO approval (exceptional circumstances).

6.7 Compensation

Merit Increases: Rating 4 → up to 8% base. Rating 3 → 3-5%. Rating 2 → 0-2% (development plan). Rating 1 → 0% (PIP). Subject to budget approval. At/above band top → lower % regardless of rating. **Compensation Bands:** Reviewed and published to managers annually. Employees may request band info from HR. Annual pay equity review conducted. **Variable Pay/Bonuses:** Discretionary — exceptional mission outcomes, company milestones, spot recognition. Not guaranteed, not part of base. Criteria determined by Executive Board + Finance Officer.

6.8 Records & Confidentiality

Performance ratings, APR docs, IDPs classified L3 (Confidential) per AZ-DATA-001. Managers only access direct team records. Calibration discussions confidential. Employees access own records via HR portal. Retention: employment + 7 years.

APPENDIX A: 90-DAY ONBOARDING CHECKLIST

Use this checklist to track progress through the onboarding plan.

Phase 1 (Days 1-30): - ☐ Badge and biometric access registered - ☐ Workstation configured to security baseline - ☐ Security awareness training completed - ☐ ITAR/EAR compliance training completed - ☐ Corporate Policies Manual Volumes 1 and 2 read in full - ☐ Architecture Overview session attended - ☐ Domain reading list completed - ☐ Phase 1 Milestone Review completed

Phase 2 (Days 31-60): - ☐ Joined active project as supervised contributor - ☐ Minimum two Merge Requests submitted and reviewed - ☐ Technical documentation piece produced - ☐ Sprint Review or Project Status Meeting attended - ☐ Phase 2 Milestone Review completed

Phase 3 (Days 61-90): - ☐ Led at least one task from definition to reviewed Merge Request - ☐ Participated as primary reviewer in a peer code review - ☐ Improved at least one documentation section - ☐ Role-Specific Certification completed - ☐ 90-Day Review completed - ☐ Individual Development Plan (IDP) established